

Ashish Kumar

CONTACT INFORMATION	1 E Chase Street, Baltimore MD, USA	Contact : +1 6679005375 E-mail: ashish.econ@gmail.com
EDUCATION	PhD Economics, Johns Hopkins University, (2022-) MA Economics, Ashoka University, 2020 GPA: 3.7/4 (magna cum laude) • Dissertation Topic - Production Linkages & Volatility in an Economy:A Network based Exploration Link, Advisor : Prof. Bhaskar Dutta BA Economics, Punjabi University, 2017 Percentage: 82% (First class with distinction)	
EXPERIENCE	Workshop Participation: Heterogeneous-Agent Macroeconomics using SSJ Toolkit (Frankfurt 2024) Link Research Assistant to Prof. Andrew Ching, July 2023-August 2023 Research Assistant to Prof Christopher Carroll, December 2022-January 2023 Research Assistant, Indian Health Outcomes, Public Health & Economics Research Centre, June 2021-May 2022 Research Assistant, Misra Centre for Financial Markets and Economy, IIM-A, April 2021-May 2021 Research Assistant, Centre for Management of Health Services, IIM-A, May 2020-March 2021 Research Intern, ICTS-TIFR, Bengaluru, May-July 2019 Link	
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Macroeconomic Theory I (Ph.D.) ,TA to Christopher D. Carroll (JHU)- Fall 2024 Elements of Macroeconomics, TA to Hellen Seshie-Nasser(JHU)- Spring 2025	
TECHNICAL SKILLS	Julia, Python, R, Fortran	
PUBLICATIONS	A. Kumar, A. S. Chakrabarti, A. Chakraborti, and T. Nandi, Distress propagation on production networks: Coarse-graining and modularity of linkages, <i>Physica A</i> , (2021) 568. (Link)	
WORKING PAPERS	How Does Misinformation Spill-Over Spatially? New Evidence from COVID-19 Drug Treatment Endorsements(with Chirantan Chatterjee and Aditya Bansal) (<i>under review at Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics</i>)(SSRN Link) Do political statements without a scientific basis on medicines cause global pharmaceutical demand spillovers during pandemics? We examine this question using novel sales data from 2018-2020 in the Indian domestic anti-malarial drug markets. Utilizing a difference-in-difference setup coupled with an event-study design framework, we exploit the endorsement by the POTUS as an exogenous shock. Additional analysis for mechanisms show that the effects are most prominent in top Indian	

regions with urban populations, better internet penetration, and population density.

The California Effect in Global Biopharmaceutical Industry: Evidence from Large Molecule Biological Drugs (with Chirantan Chatterjee , Anindya S Chakraborti, and Dr. Raja Naraynan)(*work under progress*)

Exploiting the passage of Biologics Price Competition and Innovation (BPCI) Act in 2008 as an exogenous event, we attempt to document the shift in the market structure of biologic drugs in India. The BPCIA's intent was to foster competition by creating an abbreviated pathway for the entry of biosimilars in the biologics market. That incentivized firms in India which is considered to be a hotbed of bio-pharmaceuticals industry. Our paper empirically documents that the incentive channel created by BPCIA led to market expansion, with new firms entering the market, thus leading to more product variety which ultimately brought down prices and reduced market concentration.

PHD SECOND YEAR PAPER **Quantitative Analysis of Optimal Taxation in a Lifecycle Model with OLG Demographics: In the presence of rate of return heterogeneity, differential saving behavior and stochastic earnings**

Replication Project [Link to Github repo](#) [Link to webpage](#)

Successfully replicated De Nardi's influential 2004 study, Wealth Inequality and Intergenerational Links using the Julia programming language. Verified the original results and enhanced computational efficiency, demonstrating proficiency in quantitative methods and modern programming tools.

AWARDS AND ACCOMPLISHMENT **Featured in Dean's List and awarded 'Excellence in Academic Achievement', Ashoka University**
Batch Topper: MA Economics, Ashoka University, 2020; B.A. Economics, Punjabi University, 2017